

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

What's Your Favourite Kind Of Noodle?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 20

No.	Sentence
1	Noodles may have first appeared _____.
2	They were carried along an ancient trade route by _____.
3	Local versions were shaped by _____ and new ingredients.
4	In the 1920s and 30s, noodles in the US were seen as _____.
5	A food-industry organisation wanted to promote the making of _____.
6	The story about a famous traveller was designed to _____.
7	The result was growth in _____.
8	Ramen was influenced by _____ who had moved to Japan.
9	Japanese chefs changed the imported dishes, including by adding _____.
10	Compared with many traditional foods, ramen still _____.

11 **What is the main point made about noodles in the opening topic discussion?**

- A They became popular because modern packets made them convenient.
- B Their history is mainly a story of one country exporting one recipe.
- C They spread across places and were repeatedly adapted by local cooks.
- D Their appeal depends more on ingredients than on cultural exchange.

12 **Why was the Marco Polo story promoted in the United States?**

- A It helped market dried pasta by giving it an attractive origin story.
- B It corrected a historical error about European noodle-making.
- C It explained why Asian noodles had disappeared from America.
- D It proved that dried pasta was invented in thirteenth-century Italy.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 13 **What is the attitude toward the claim that pasta came from Marco Polo's trip?**
- A It is treated as a confirmed discovery with broad evidence.
 - B It is presented as a harmless legend with no commercial purpose.
 - C It is accepted only for explaining Italian cooking traditions.
 - D It is rejected as a story created to promote pasta sales.
- 14 **According to the explanation, what happened after the promotional story was used?**
- A People became less interested in imported Asian noodles.
 - B Pasta sales increased because the story served its purpose.
 - C Pasta makers stopped focusing on dried pasta production.
 - D American consumers demanded only fresh wheat noodles.
- 15 **How did Chinese noodle dishes become more Japanese?**
- A Chefs kept their basic appeal but adjusted them for local tastes.
 - B Chefs replaced noodles with sushi-style ingredients.
 - C Chefs removed foreign influences to preserve tradition.
 - D Chefs copied Chinese recipes without changing them.
- 16 **What does the ramen enthusiast seem to value most about ramen?**
- A Its close connection with one unchanged recipe.
 - B Its status as the oldest Japanese noodle dish.
 - C Its ability to keep developing beyond fixed norms.
 - D Its simple preparation using packet noodles only.
- 17 **In the chef's comment, what does "these dishes" most probably refer to?**
- A Modern versions of dried pasta in America.
 - B Toppings added to instant noodle packets.
 - C Traditional foods such as sushi and hotpot.
 - D Chinese noodle dishes that inspired ramen.
- 18 **What can be inferred about the Japanese chefs who adapted the dishes?**
- A They viewed Chinese noodles as unsuitable for Japan.
 - B They admired them but wanted a more local version.
 - C They were trying to reproduce Italian pasta culture.
 - D They wanted ramen to stop changing over time.

19 **Why are toppings and slices of meat mentioned?**

- A To show practical examples of changes that shaped ramen.
- B To argue that ramen became less Japanese over time.
- C To compare ramen with dried pasta manufacturing.
- D To explain why noodles no longer link to the past.

20 **What is the broader implication of the noodle examples?**

- A Food history becomes reliable only when linked to famous travellers.
- B Successful noodle dishes usually reject earlier cultural influences.
- C Noodle traditions often survive by changing as they move between cultures.
- D Modern convenience has ended the need for traditional flavours.